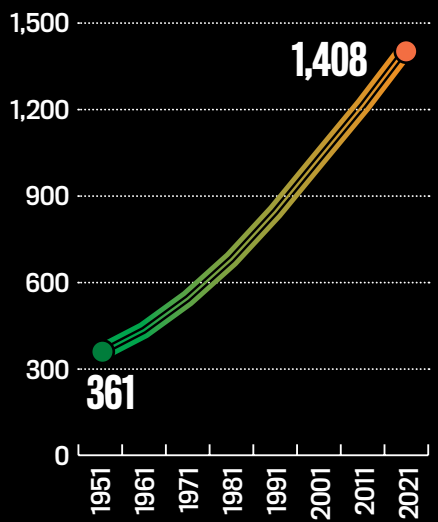


Graphics by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY

There is much that India can take pride in as it celebrates 75 years of its Independence and much more that it needs to do. Especially when it comes to fulfilling the fundamental duties and responsibilities of the State to provide the bare necessities of life to every Indian so that they can live with dignity and in hope. India's population has grown fourfold since 1947, which is one reason why policymakers have had trouble keeping pace. At 1.4 billion, India is now the second most populous country in the world, next only to China. If over 200 million

POPULATION OF INDIA

(in million)



Source: Economic Survey, 2021-22; MoF

POPULATION BOON OR BANE?

India's population has grown fourfold since Independence; we are now a country with the second-highest population in the world. There are demographic dividends to being a young nation, when over 70 per cent of your population is under 35. But more people also means more pressure on resources and an uneven distribution of the fruits of development.